The outline of the volume

Examining our overarching questions, this book is divided into four parts. This first part of the book looks at bilateral relations between India and China. It starts with a chapter by **Jo Inge Bekkevold** examining how the role and position of India in China's foreign policy since 1949 have changed according to Beijing's evolving grand strategy. China's policy towards India has mainly been informed by four overarching considerations. First, it is at any given time shaped by the balance of power in the international system. Second, it is informed by the potential threat India constitutes to stability on China's western frontier. The third influence is China's evolving geostrategy, meaning the main geographic thrust of its foreign policy. And the fourth is Beijing's shifting priorities towards power politics versus wealth and economic growth in pursuing its grand strategy. Bekkevold applies these variables to explore China's India policy since the establishment of the People's Republic in 1949 and discuss whether China now is pursuing a relatively more assertive policy towards India. The next chapter, written by **S. Kalyanaraman**, outlines the long-term trends in New Delhi's policy on China from 1949 until today and divides this period into four distinct phases. From the establishment of the People's Republic in 1949 until the 1962 War, India sought to forge an instrumentally cooperative relationship with China. Following the shock of the 1962 war, India balanced against China through both a military build-up and the forging of an alliance with the Soviet Union. Starting with the late 1980s, a third phase arose when India began to hedge against China in order to stabilise their competition, improve economic linkages, and coordinate diplomatic positions. Finally, the chapter discusses if we are now witnessing the early signs of a fourth phase as India deepens security cooperation with the United States and its major Asian allies in the context of